

Balance — User Guide for Judges

Balance helps a student whose plan no longer fits the day. It shows the overload, compares safe ways to fix it, changes nothing until the student confirms, and can undo every confirmed change.

Time needed: about 10 minutes. **Help needed:** none.

Quick path

Step	Page	What you will do	Time
1	—	Install the app and sign in	2 min
2	TODAY	See a 2-hour overload and five workload bars	1 min
3	QUESTS	Look at the two tasks behind the overload	1 min
4	COUNCIL	Compare options and confirm a plan	2 min
5	COUNCIL	Undo the plan from Plan history	1 min
6	SANCTUARY	Protect 30 minutes of rest, then remove it	2 min
7	JOURNEY	Read the weekly summary and achievements	1 min

Before you start

You need	Where to get it
An Android phone (Android 7.0 or later) with internet	—
The Balance app	Latest release → download <code>app-release.apk</code>
The judge account email and password	In our submission form. They are never stored in this repository.
The sample date	In our submission form, next to the account details.

The bottom bar has five pages: **TODAY**, **QUESTS**, **COUNCIL**, **SANCTUARY**, **JOURNEY**. Each page shows a practical name with a game-style label beside it, for example *Workload Overview · World Status*.

1. Install and sign in

1. On the phone, open the release link and download `app-release.apk`.
2. Open the downloaded file. If Android asks, allow installing apps from this source, then tap **Install**.
3. Open **Balance**, enter the judge email and password, and tap **Sign in**.

You should see the **TODAY** page. If a "Local preview" banner appears at the top, this is not the release build; reinstall from the release link.

2. See the overload (TODAY)

1. Use the **Previous day / Next day** arrows to open the **sample date**.

2. The **Time capacity** card shows **5h planned** against **3h available** (09:00–12:00) and a red **2h over** tag. The planned work does not fit.
3. The **World Status** card shows five bars in a fixed order: **Mental, Time, Physical, Social, Errands**. Bars without enough data say **Unknown**. Balance never treats missing data as zero or guesses it.
4. Optional: the daily review asks for energy and hours of rest. Tap **Save review** or **Skip for now**. Skipping has no penalty.

3. Look at the tasks (QUESTS)

The sample day has two study tasks:

Task	Length	When	Deadline
Judge demo: flexible report	3h	Scheduled 09:00–12:00 on the sample date	The next day, 17:00
Judge demo: deadline work	2h	Not scheduled	The sample date, 17:00

Together they need 5 hours, but only 3 hours are available.

- Each task card shows its category (Study, Errand, Social, Exercise or Other), its flexibility, and whether it is **Protected**. Protected commitments such as a work shift, family duty or sleep minimum are never moved to make a plan fit.
- Optional: tap **Add task**, then **Cancel**. A new task cannot be saved without a category.

4. Compare and confirm a plan (COUNCIL)

1. Open **COUNCIL** and go to the sample date. The page says *Suggestions only. Nothing moves until confirmed*.
2. Read the suggested option. It moves **2 hours of the flexible report to the next day**, where 2 hours are free (09:00–11:00) and the report's deadline is still met. Each option lists the **Cost**, what stays **Protected**, the **Room created**, and anything to **Check before confirming**.
3. Tap **Compare plans** to see the options and the capacity of every affected day.
4. Select the option and tap **Confirm selected plan**, then confirm in the final preview.
5. The plan-updated screen lists the moved work. Tap **Return to Today**: the sample date now fits, and the next day shows the moved 2 hours.

5. Undo the plan (COUNCIL)

1. Open **COUNCIL** and tap the **Plan history** icon (clock) at the top right.
2. Open the plan marked **Confirmed** and tap **Undo this plan**.
3. Plan history now marks it **Undone**. On **TODAY**, the sample date is **2h over** again and the next day is free.

If the tasks were edited after confirming, Undo is refused with an explanation instead of overwriting the newer changes.

Please always undo your plan, so the sample day stays ready for the next judge.

6. Protect rest time (SANCTUARY)

Recovery time is optional. Balance only lets you protect time that is genuinely free.

1. Open **SANCTUARY** and tap **Add recovery time**.

2. Choose the **day after the sample date**, from 09:00 to 09:30, and tap **Save**. The slot appears as **Protected time**. Choosing an activity is optional.
3. Try the same on a day with no available time: the app explains that recovery time must fit inside available time and offers **Go to Today**.
4. Marking an activity done does not change any workload score. Rest is not graded.
5. **Please remove the slot afterwards**: open its menu (:) → **Remove**. It occupies the free time that the Council plan in step 4 needs.

7. Weekly summary and achievements (JOURNEY)

1. Open **JOURNEY**. It shows a private weekly summary for the selected week. Days without a record say **No record**; past scores are never invented.
2. Optional: tap **Add optional reflection**, write one sentence and tap **Save**.
3. Scroll to **Achievements**: seven cards, each with its unlock condition. Your steps above can unlock **Safe Trade-off**, **Deadline Safety**, **Protected Rest** and **Reflection**. Each badge is awarded once per account, so cards may already be unlocked if another judge used this account first.
4. **Team Coordination** stays **Locked**. It needs shared tasks, which are planned for a later version.

There are no streaks, rankings or penalties for skipping.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"Could not connect" with Try again	Check the internet connection, then tap Try again . Data already on screen stays visible.
The sample date is not 2h over	Check that you are on the sample date. If a plan is still confirmed, undo it in COUNCIL → Plan history .
Council shows No Feasible Plan	A recovery slot may be occupying the next day. Remove it in SANCTUARY (step 6.5).
Sign-in fails	Check the email and password from the submission form for typing errors.
"Can't install app"	Uninstall any earlier Balance test build first, then install again.

What Balance does not claim

- Scores describe recorded planning data. Balance is not a medical, diagnostic or mental-health tool.
- Android is the supported platform. iOS has not been tested on a device, and the web build is not part of this submission.
- Every task needs a deadline; a "No deadline" option is not available yet.
- The app is currently English-only. Bahasa Melayu and Chinese are planned.
- Shared tasks and the Team Coordination achievement are planned for a later version.